1951

F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

32

F J 1022/600

FROM A.O. Minute (C.H. JOHNSTON)

No.

Dated 19/6/51

Received in Registry— 20/6/51

J. P. T. - Agreed announcement on China and Formosa.

REFERENCES

MINUTES

21/6.

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)	(Index)
M 52/6	3/9/5

39451

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FJ 1022/600 Enclr

CONFIDENTIAL

JAPANESE PEACE TREATY: AGREED ANNOUNCEMENT ON CHINA AND FORMOSA.

Mr. Tomlinson of the Embassy in Washington has just telephoned me to say that Mr. Rusk has told him that the U.S. Government have had second thoughts about the timing of the proposed announcement, and, if we agree, would like to hold this up for a short time, perhaps 24 hours, perhaps longer. The Embassy would let us know as soon as a new time for the release of the statement was proposed.

2. Mr. Rusk had emphasised that this meant no change in policy, but was simply due to the factor of timing.

3. I undertook to let Mr. Tomlinson know as soon as possible whether we saw any objection to this change of procedure.

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

There seems to be no objection from our point of view to the proposed delay. We agreed originally to having the release to-day in order to meet the U.S. Government's sense of urgency. The only disadvantage about postponement now is that the Commonwealth Relations Office have already telegraphed the text of the statement to Commonwealth Governments; they are now preparing a draft telegram explaining the American proposal and asking Commonwealth Governments to treat ~~the announcement~~ it as secret until the new time of release is given. This telegram will be sent off if the proposal that we should agree to the Americans is approved. I think we should however ask the Embassy in Washington to explain that the risks of leakage are increased by the fact that the text of the announcement has been sent to Commonwealth Governments, and we should recommend that the delay in issuing the statement should therefore be as short as possible.

Meanwhile I have asked News Department to suspend their

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Copies of this minute are being submitted to the Minister of State and Sir W. Strang.

C.H. Johnston.

(C.H. Johnston)
19th June, 1951

Sir E. Dening.

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Wm. 19/6.